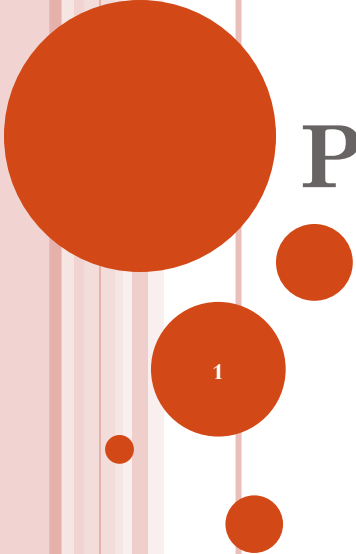




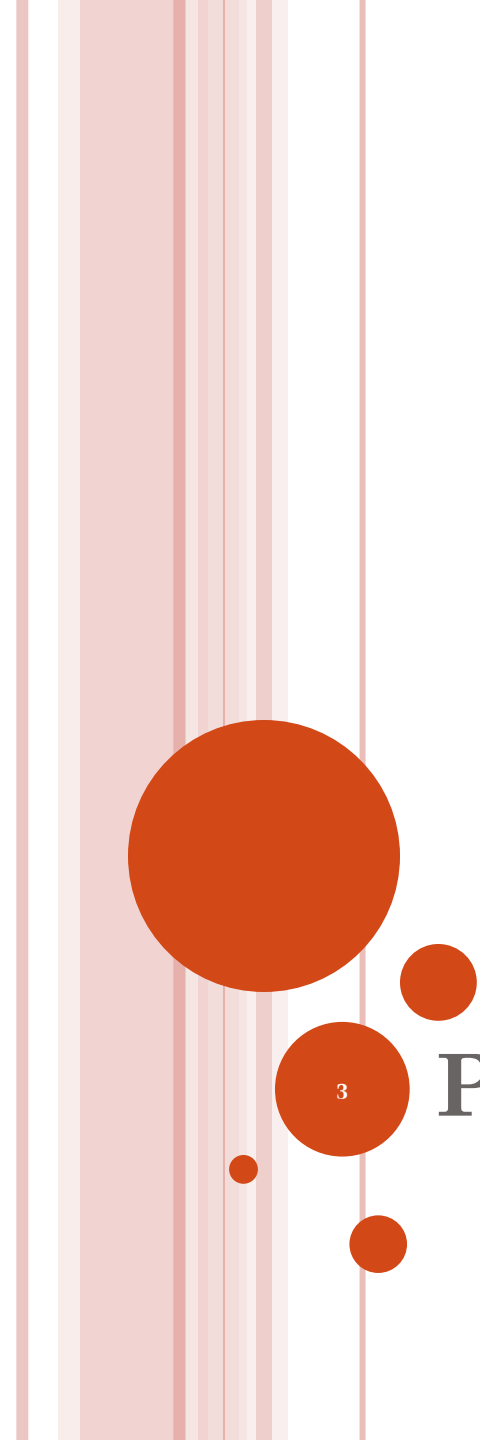
LECTURE 4: PSYCHOLOGY & HEALTH IMPACTS

Assoc. Prof. Kullaya Pisitsungkagarn
Ph.D. & DPsych.

OUTLINE FOR THE LECTURE



- Practice: Character's Personality Analysis
- Administrative Work
 - Upcoming Exam I
- Personality and relevant impacts
 - Physical Impacts
 - Psychological Impacts



PRACTICE: CHARACTER'S PERSONALITY PROBLEM ANALYSIS

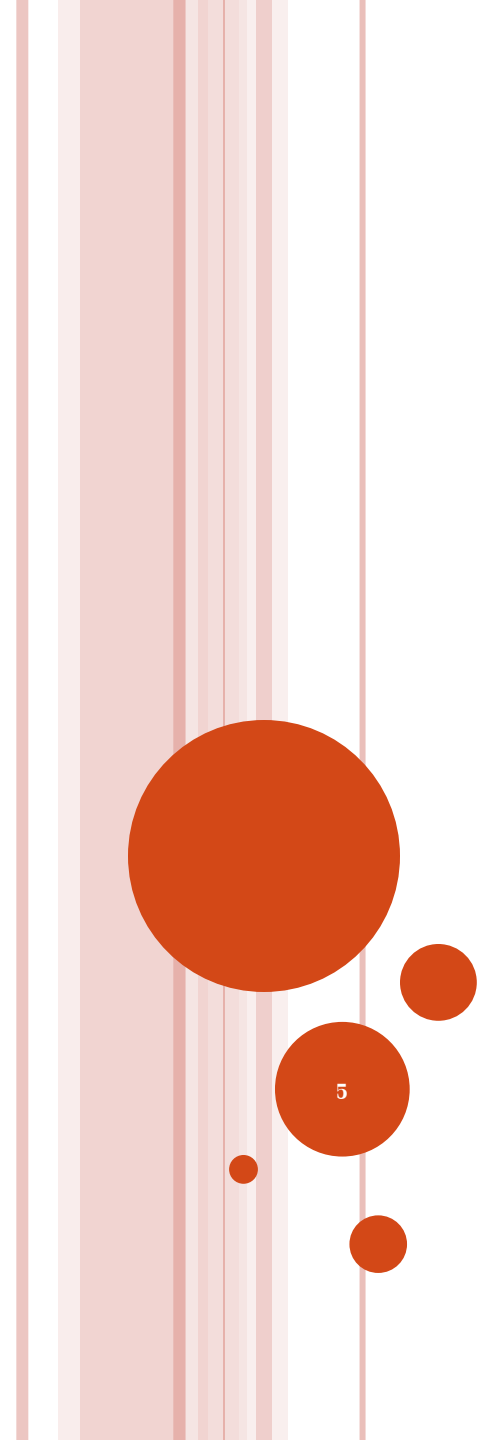
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GROUP ACTIVITY (TO BE SUBMITTED INDIVIDUALLY BY EACH GROUP MEMBER)

- In a group of 5-6 members, practice applying the personality theories below to explain **Giant's tendency for physical aggression**. Rate how well each theory applies to the aggression, using a scale of 1 (least applicable)- 5 (most applicable) and provide relevant explanations.



Approaches	Applicability (1: Min, 5: Max)	Explanations
1) Genetic Approach		
2) Psychosocial Theory		
3) Behaviorism		
4) Social Cognitive Theory		
5) Humanistic Approach		



ADMINISTRATIVE WORK (PLEASE SEE QUIZ REMINDER)

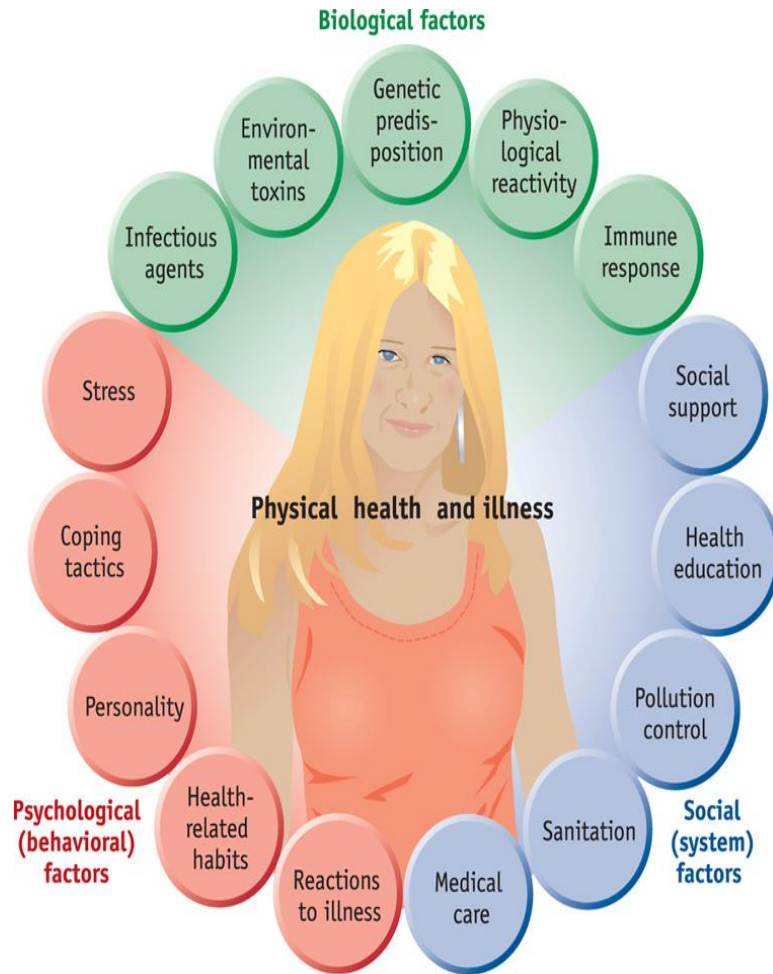
PSYCHOLOGY & HEALTH IMPACTS

PSYCHOLOGICAL & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- **Health psychology** examines how psychological factors are related to the **promotion and maintenance** of health, through the explanation of **causes, prevention, and treatment** of physical illness.

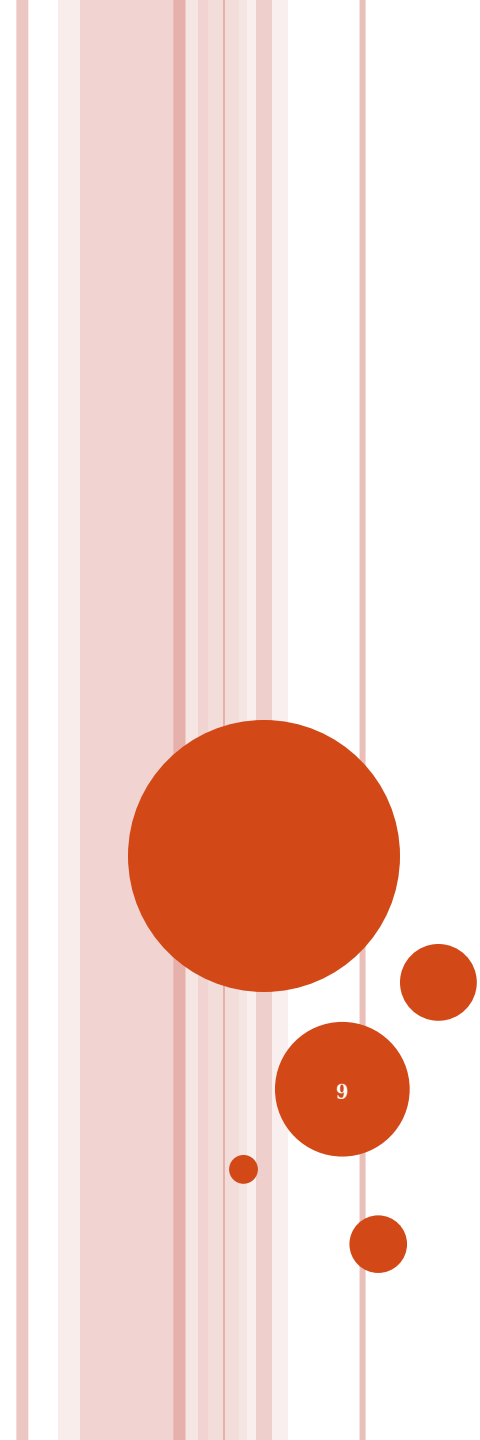


PSYCHOLOGICAL & PHYSICAL HEALTH

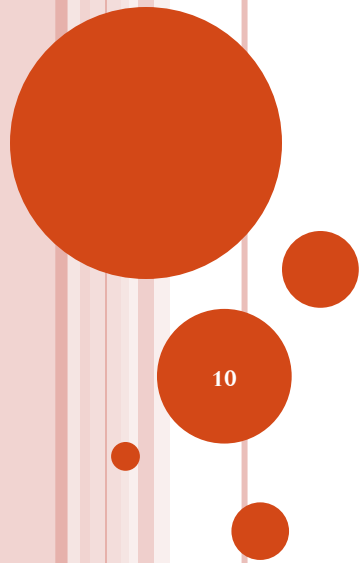


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- Health Psychology advocates the **biopsychosocial** model which suggests that illness is caused by a complex **interaction** between biological, psychological, and socio-cultural factors.



PSYCHOLOGICAL FACTORS AND PHYSICAL HEALTH

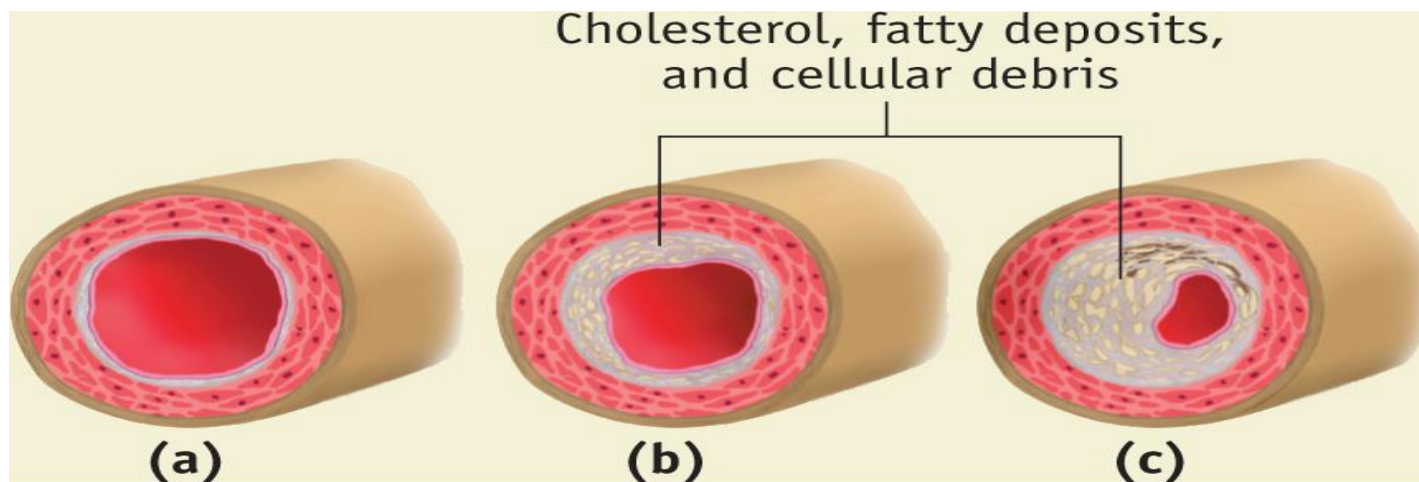


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1) PERSONALITY

PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Research evidence suggests an association between coronary heart disease risk and **Type A personality** (i.e., a competitive orientation, impatience, proneness to stress, anger, and hostility).



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Test yourself
 - How much are you oriented to **Type A personality**?
 - Please respond to the 20-item 7-point Type A personality questionnaire. Keep in mind **the anchor format** of the questionnaire.



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

○ Type A assessment outcome interpretations:



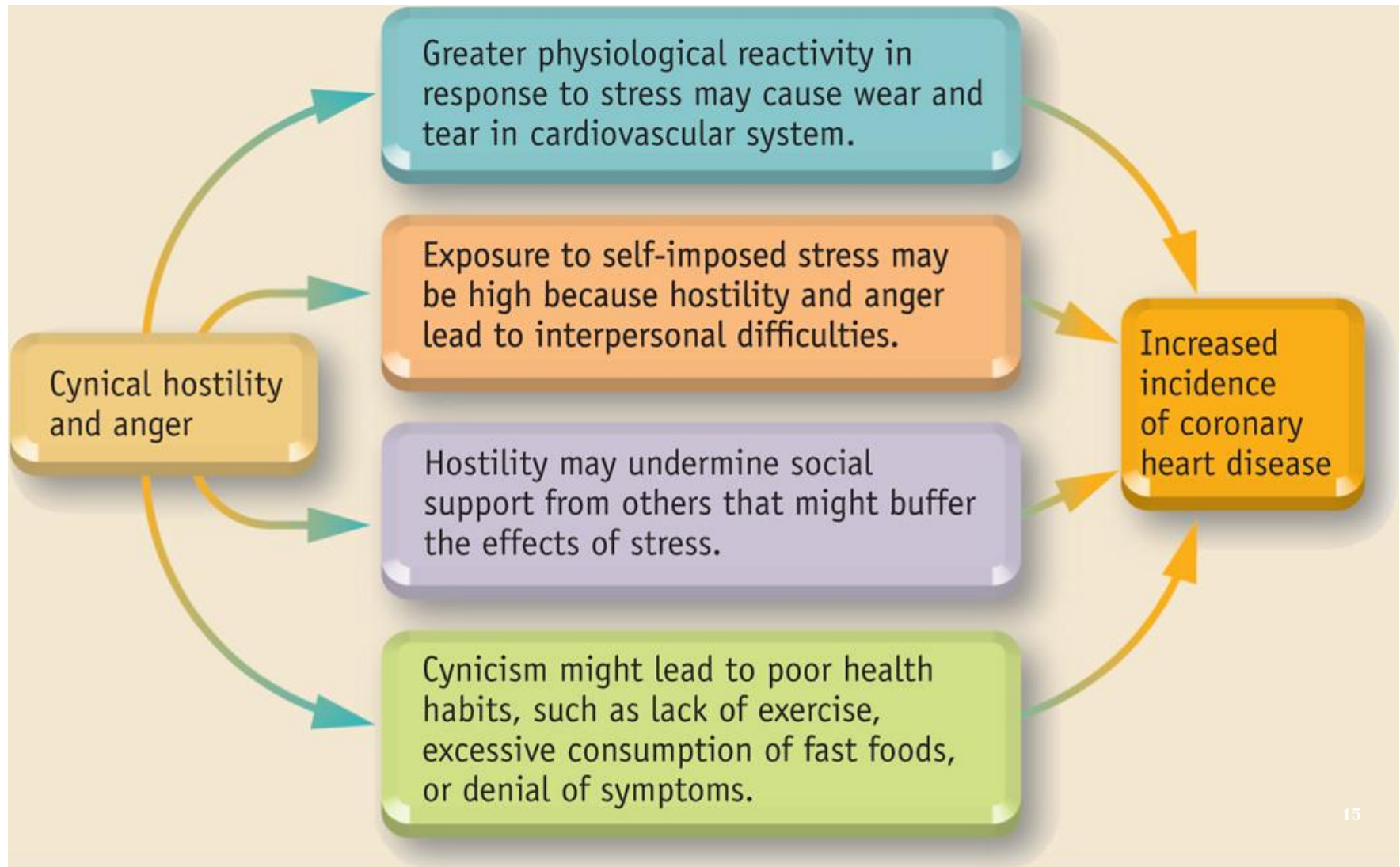
110 & Beyond	Type A1: Strongly Type A
80 – 109	Type A2: Somewhat Type A
60 – 79	Type AB: A mix between Types A & B
30 - 59	Type B2: Somewhat Type B
0 – 29	Type B1: Strongly Type B

PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Personality factors
 - Of its various components, the **“anger–hostility”** component of Type A personality has the strongest link to coronary heart disease.



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Personality could affect our **emotions** (i.e., stress) which in turn affects our **physical health**.
- **Type A personality** could contribute to stress.
- E.g., stress is associated with:
 - Rheumatoid arthritis
 - Back pain
 - Asthma
 - Gastrointestinal disorders
 - Compromised immune systems



2) STRESS

STRESS



- Stress occurs when one experiences “circumstances that are threatening or are **perceived** to threaten one’s well-being and tax one’s coping abilities”.

STRESS

- Stress is a **normal** part of life.
- Even positive life changes (e.g., marriage, work promotion, having a baby) could be perceived as stressful if you are unsure about your coping resources.



PRACTICE

- As many as you can within 1 minute, list the situations that can lead to stress.

- -----
- -----
- -----
- -----
- -----
- -----



STRESS

- Stress can be **positive**
- Eustress vs. Distress
 - Eustress: The stress is converted into **positive energy** and becomes **motivating**.

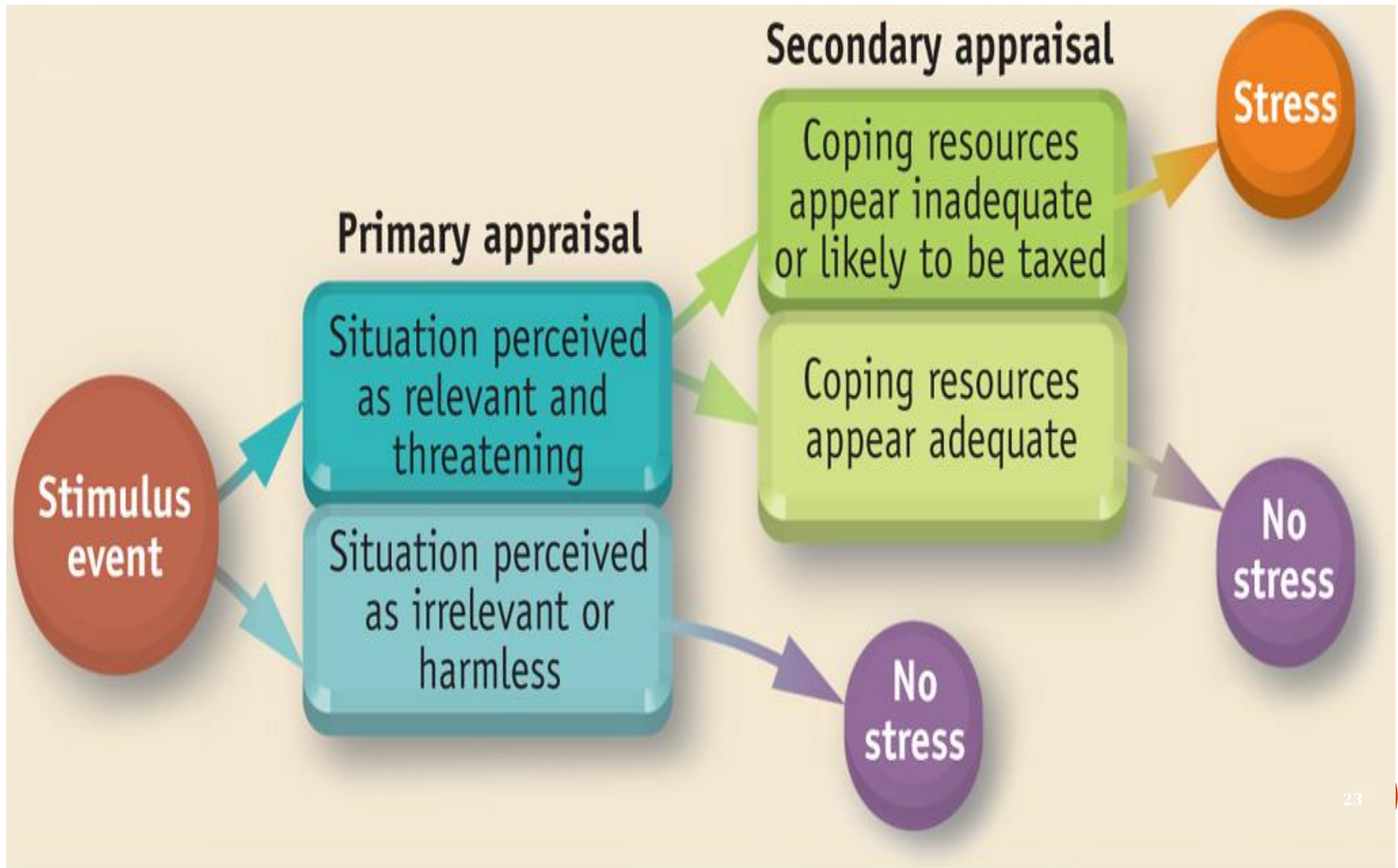


STRESS & ITS CHARACTERISTICS



- Stress is **subjective**.
 - **Not** everyone feels the same degree of stress from the same situation.
- One's **appraisal** (i.e., evaluation) of the situation results in the stress experienced.

STRESS



STRESS & ITS CHARACTERISTICS

- Primary stress appraisal: An initial evaluation of whether an event is **relevant and threatening** to oneself:
 - Irrelevant
 - Relevant **but not** threatening
 - Relevant **and** threatening
- The view that an event is *relevant and threatening* leads to stress.



STRESS & ITS CHARACTERISTICS

- Would these situations lead to stress?
 - 1) You were talking casually with your partner in a restaurant booth.
 - 2) A stranger came looking for her phone at your booth--- she thought she might have dropped it there.
 - 3) Your partner helped the stranger search for the phone and asked for your help.
 - 4) When you got home, you realized that your wallet was lost--- your might have dropped it during the search.



STRESS & ITS CHARACTERISTICS

- Secondary stress appraisal: An evaluation of one's **coping resources** and options for dealing with the stress.
 - The perception of coping resources will determine the **intensity** of the stress experienced.



STRESS MANAGEMENT

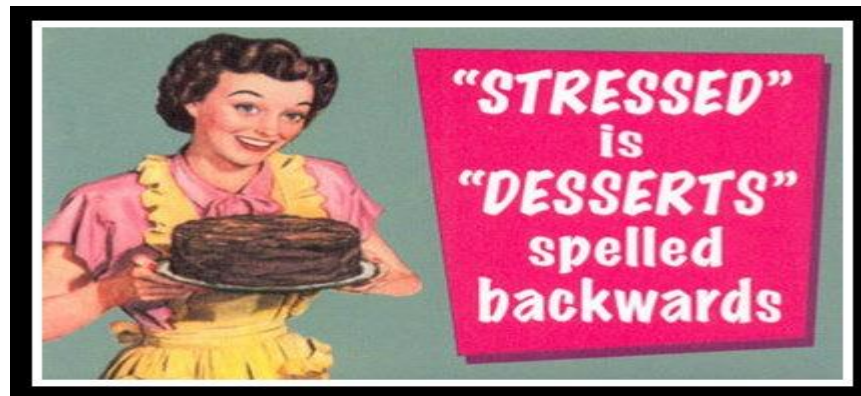
- We can use the understanding about the two appraisal processes outline to keep stress **proportional** by reevaluating:
 - The **relevance** of the potential stress
 - The degree of **threats** imposed
 - The **resources** you have
- While we'll further discuss ways to reduce stress in subsequent lectures, make the most of your existing resources
 - **CU Student Wellness Jamjuri 9**
(02-218-0540) <https://wellness.chula.ac.th/>



3) COPING STRATEGIES

COPING STRATEGIES AND PHYSICAL HEALTH

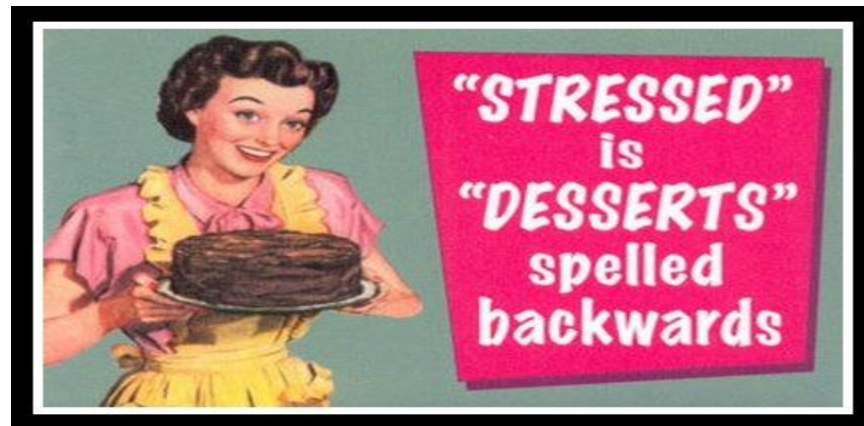
- Coping is essential for managing stress
- Coping strategies vary in terms of their **effectiveness and impacts** on physical health.
- One coping method that can impact our health is emotional eating.



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

○ Emotional eating:

- Eating to satisfy **emotional needs**, rather than the physiological ones.
- The eating generally involves **high calorie food** and is generally done **in private**.
- Could lead to **Bulimia Nervosa**, which is when ones attempt to subsequently eliminate the caloric intake.



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Bulimia Nervosa
 - Binge eating: Without control, eating an amount of food **larger** than what would be expected in a similar period **and**
 - **Compensatory** behaviors (e.g., excessive exercise, purging)
 - Occurring at least **once a week** for **3 months**.
 - Self-evaluation is unduly influenced by **body shape & weight**.



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Emotional eating: Contributing factors
 - **Stress**: Emotional eating can be associated with personality factors (e.g., Type A personality & neuroticism) & stressful events (e.g., exam periods)
 - A lack of effective ways to **regulate** your emotions (e.g., ways to reduce your stress).



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Emotional eating: Contributing factors
 - The **association** between food and positive emotions:
 - **Classical conditioning**: The associations between food and positive attributes (e.g., family warmth, friendship, celebration) and positive emotions.



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Emotional eating: Contributing factors
 - Classical conditioning: The **association** between food and positive emotions, and hence the use of food to regulate your emotion.



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Emotional eating: Contributing factors
 - The association of food and positive emotions:
 - **Operant conditioning**: Food leads to rewarding **outcomes**/experiences (e.g., hunger satisfaction, pleasant taste and aroma).



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH



- Emotional eating:
Contributing factors
- **Strict dieting** can backfire:
 - **Preoccupation** with food
 - Nutrition **deprivation** & hunger

PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Emotional eating:
Contributing factors
- Strict dieting can backfire:
 - A **slip** during strict dieting can lead to an **all-or-nothing** thinking & emotional eating (e.g., *“Having a bite of a cupcake, I have ruined my diet plan. So today is my cheat day. I’ll spoil myself and try again tomorrow”*).



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH



- Emotional eating: Contributing factors

Self-worth is based on body image



Strict dieting



Food preoccupation



Nutrition deprivation

Rule breaking



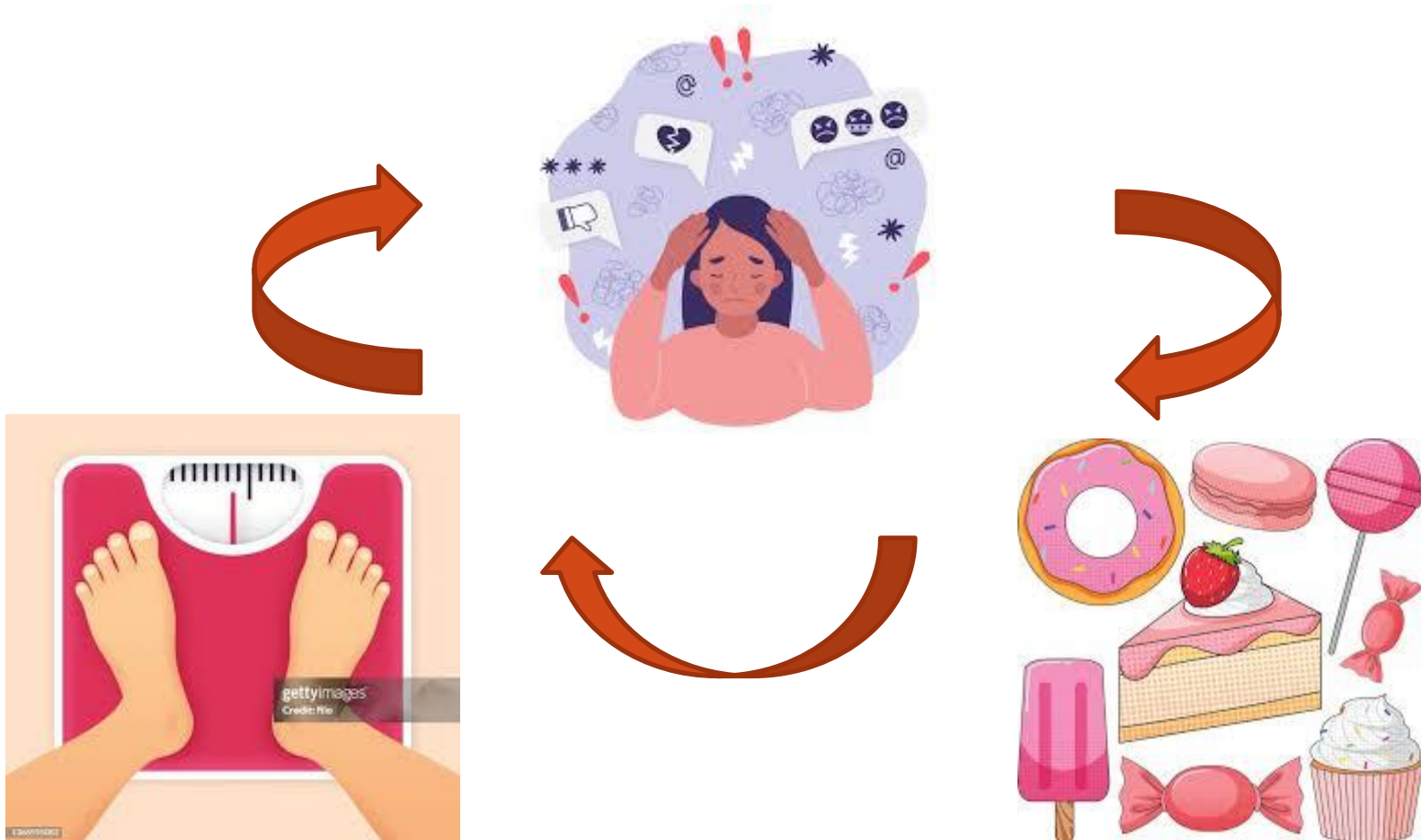
Self-criticism/All-or-nothing thinking



Emotional Eating

PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Emotional eating: Its **vicious** cycle



PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH



- Reducing emotional eating
 - When experiencing an urge to eat, check your **body signals** and the reasons for your urge.
 - If it is emotional eating, try to **delay or resist** the urge.
 - If you can't, choose a **“healthier”** food choice. Eat **slowly & mindfully**.
 - Your **healthier food choices**

•

PERSONALITY FACTORS & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Reducing emotional eating
 - Equip yourself with alternative & more adaptive ways to **regulate** your emotions.
 - Ways to regulate your emotions
 -
 -
 -
 - Address the **cause(s)** of your negative emotion!



PERSONALITY FACTOR & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Similar to emotional eating, some **health-impairing lifestyles** may serve a coping function in emotion regulation and are used to reduce stress.
- **Game addiction:** Other than emotion regulation, sometimes games serve the functions in enhancing our **social connection and fantasy**.



PERSONALITY FACTOR & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Similar to emotional eating, some health-impairing lifestyles may serve a function in emotion regulation.
- **Smoking/Drinking:**
 - Sometimes, they are used by some as a way to reduce stress/regulate emotions.
 - Also, they might be viewed by some as a way to enhance **social connection** and maintain group membership.



PERSONALITY FACTOR & PHYSICAL HEALTH

- Smoking/drinking
 - These may also be perpetuated by **pluralistic ignorance** (i.e., the hesitation to state your questions/disagreements, which in turn perpetuates others' perception of the consensus).



PERSONALITY FACTOR & PHYSICAL HEALTH

○ Smoking/drinking

- With pluralistic ignorance, you may not want to drink but others seem all right to do so. Thus, you **do not voice your concerns**.
- Others also look for signals from you.
- When you do not voice your concerns, they continue with the drinking.



SUMMARY

- Various aspects of psychology can be used to explain health-related behaviors.
 - Personality
 - Stress
 - Coping strategies

